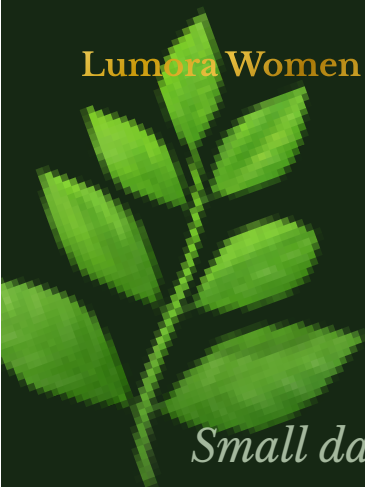


Lumora Women

A 6-MODULE POSTPARTUM WELLNESS COURSE

Bloom Again

Small daily habits that help you feel like yourself again

No dieting. No calorie counting. No overwhelm. Just practical, gentle habits that support your digestion, hormones, energy, metabolism, and nervous system from the inside out.

- 1 Gentle Morning Reset
 - 2 Eat Better Without Dieting
 - 3 Digestion and Gut Support
 - 4 Movement That Works Postpartum
 - 5 Cycle-Aware Wellness Habits
 - 6 Stress, Mood and Lasting Habits
- 

lumorawomen.com

Before you begin

First, I want you to know that how you are feeling right now makes complete sense. Your body has been through an extraordinary journey. Growing a human, giving birth, recovering, and caring for a baby while the rest of the world kept moving. That is a lot.

If you are feeling tired, puffy, disconnected from your body, and wondering where your energy went, you are not broken. You are depleted, and your body is asking for some gentle care.

This course is not about restriction. It is not about counting anything. It is not about punishing your body into a new shape. It is about adding small, nourishing habits, one at a time, that help your body feel supported, balanced, and energized again.

You do not need to be perfect. You just need to show up, gently, as often as you can. That is enough. Let us begin.

IMPORTANT DISCLAIMER

I am a wellness coach, not a doctor, not a registered dietitian, and not a certified healthcare professional of any kind. Everything in this course is for **educational and informational purposes only** and is not intended as medical advice, diagnosis, or treatment of any condition. The habits and information shared here are based on general wellness research and my own personal experience. Individual results will vary. Please always consult your own healthcare provider before making changes to your diet, exercise routine, or wellness habits, especially if you are managing a postpartum health condition, taking medication, or have been advised otherwise by a medical professional. Your doctor is your partner. Use both.

With love, your Bloom Again course

MODULE ONE · 5 LESSONS

Gentle Morning Reset

How you start your morning shapes your whole day. Your energy, your cravings, your mood, your digestion. These five small shifts take less than ten minutes total and the difference they make is not subtle.



Lesson 1.1 — Warm Water Before Anything Else

WHAT THIS IS

Before your coffee, before your phone, before you do anything for anyone else, drink a glass of warm or room temperature water. That is the whole habit.

WHY IT MATTERS

You wake up mildly dehydrated every single morning. Your digestion, your metabolism, your brain, and your energy levels all need hydration before they can function properly. Warm water gently activates your digestive system and signals to your body that it is time to wake up from the inside out. And here is something most people do not realize: thirst and hunger use remarkably similar signals in the brain. A lot of that morning foggy and urge to reach for something sweet right away is often just your body asking for water. Starting with hydration can quiet those early cravings before they even begin.

WHAT TO DO

Set a glass of water on your nightstand before you go to sleep. When your alarm goes off, drink it before you stand up. Add a squeeze of fresh lemon if you enjoy it. It supports digestion and tastes intentional, which honestly helps you stick to it.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Tonight, put a glass of water on your nightstand. Tomorrow morning, drink it before anything else. Do this every day for one week and notice how your mornings begin to feel different.



Lesson 1.2 — Get Outside for Morning Light

WHAT THIS IS

Within the first hour of waking up, get your face in natural light. Outside is best, but a sunny window works. Even five or ten minutes is enough.

WHY IT MATTERS

Morning light resets your body's internal clock, which is responsible for when you feel sleepy, when you feel hungry, when you feel alert, and when you naturally wind down. When that clock is off, and for most postpartum moms it is, you feel tired at the wrong times, wired when you want to sleep, and off-rhythm all day. Light is genuinely one of the most powerful free tools you have.

WHAT TO DO

Step outside while your coffee brews. Sit near an open window during the first quiet moment you get. Take a quick walk to the end of the driveway. It does not need to be long. You just need light on your face while the morning is still early.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Tomorrow morning, after your water, step outside for five minutes. Leave your phone inside. Just stand in the light and breathe. That is it.



Lesson 1.3 — A Breakfast That Actually Keeps You Full

WHAT THIS IS

Starting your morning with a real source of protein. Eggs, Greek yogurt, cottage cheese, a protein smoothie. Something filling that your body can actually use.

WHY IT MATTERS

A protein-rich breakfast is one of the single most effective things you can do for your blood sugar, your energy, and your cravings for the rest of the day. When you start with a bowl of cereal, a piece of toast, or nothing at all, your blood sugar spikes and then drops. By mid-morning you are starving, reaching for sugar, and wondering why you have no willpower. You do not have a willpower problem. You have a breakfast problem. Protein changes that completely.

SIMPLE OPTIONS THAT WORK

- Two scrambled eggs with avocado toast
- Greek yogurt with berries and a small handful of granola
- Cottage cheese with sliced fruit
- A smoothie with protein powder, banana, nut butter, and milk of your choice
- Overnight oats with Greek yogurt stirred in

YOUR ACTION STEP

Plan your breakfasts for the next three days right now. Just pick from the list above or choose your own. Make sure each one has at least one real protein source. That is the only rule.



Lesson 1.4 — The Simple Coffee Timing Shift

WHAT THIS IS

A small but meaningful change: have your water, then eat something, then have your coffee. Not instead of coffee. Just after a little food first.

WHY IT MATTERS

Drinking coffee on a completely empty stomach spikes cortisol, which is your stress hormone, more aggressively than it would on a fed stomach. High morning cortisol throws off your blood sugar, drives cravings, increases fatigue later in the day, and keeps your body in a mild stress state before you have even started your morning. You do not have to give up coffee. Just eat something first, even a few bites, to buffer the response.

YOUR ACTION STEP

For the next week, follow this order every morning: water, then food, then coffee. Notice how your energy and mood feel by noon compared to before.



Lesson 1.5 — Five Minutes That Belong to You

WHAT THIS IS

One tiny moment at the beginning of your day that is quiet, intentional, and entirely yours. Before the demands start. Before you are needed by everyone else. Just five minutes.

WHY IT MATTERS

When you wake up and immediately go into reactive mode, answering to every need around you from the very first second, your nervous system stays in a low-grade stress state all day. Creating even a brief intentional moment for yourself at the start of the morning helps regulate your stress response and sets a completely different tone for everything that follows.

OPTIONS THAT WORK FOR BUSY MOMS

- Sit quietly with your warm water for three minutes before getting up
- Write down one thing you are grateful for and one thing you are looking forward to
- Take five slow breaths before you pick up your phone
- Put on one song you love while you get ready
- Step outside and breathe in the morning air for a few minutes

YOUR ACTION STEP

Pick one thing from that list. Just one. Do it tomorrow before you check your phone. That single moment is a form of nervous system care and it compounds over time.

MODULE 1 CHECKLIST — YOUR MORNING RESET HABITS

- ☐ Glass of water on nightstand tonight
- ☐ Getting outside or near a sunny window within the first hour
- ☐ Three days of protein breakfasts planned
- ☐ Coffee coming after water and food
- ☐ One quiet morning moment chosen and protected

MODULE TWO · 7 LESSONS

Eat Better Without Dieting

No calorie counting. No macro spreadsheets. Just a clear, visual way to understand what nourishing your body actually looks like and why it works.



Lesson 2.1 — Whole Foods vs. Processed Foods

THE SIMPLE VERSION

A whole food is something close to how it came out of the ground or off the animal. An egg. An apple. A piece of chicken. Sweet potato. Oats. A processed food has been significantly changed from its original form, usually with additives, refined starches, and sugar to make it taste good and last on a shelf.

WHY THIS MATTERS FOR YOUR BODY

Whole foods give your body steady fuel, fiber, vitamins, minerals, and information it knows how to use. Ultra-processed foods tend to cause blood sugar swings, more intense cravings, energy crashes, bloating, and inflammation. You do not have to be perfect. But every time you lean toward a more real version of something, your body notices.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Identify one processed food you eat regularly this week. Think of one whole food swap you could try. Just one. Small swaps made consistently matter far more than total overhauls that do not last.



Lesson 2.2 — The Simple Balanced Plate

FORGET MACROS. THINK VISUAL.

- Half the plate covered in vegetables or salad
- A quarter of the plate with quality protein
- A quarter of the plate with a whole food carb like rice, sweet potato, or whole grain
- A small amount of healthy fat drizzled over or on the side

WHY THIS WORKS

This combination creates blood sugar stability, keeps you full for real, supports digestion, and gives your body everything it needs without any counting or tracking. It is not a strict rule. It is a visual guide you can use anywhere, at home, at a restaurant, at your mother-in-law's house. And it works.

YOUR ACTION STEP

At your next dinner, look at your plate. Does it roughly match this? Do not stress about perfection. Just start noticing what is there and what might be missing.



Lesson 2.3 — Protein at Every Single Meal

WHAT TO DO

Every meal, every snack, should include at least one real source of protein. Not optional. Not when you remember. Every time you eat.

WHY MOST POSTPARTUM MOMS ARE NOT GETTING ENOUGH

Protein is the most filling nutrient you can eat. It supports your metabolism, your muscle tissue, your hormone production, your hair, your skin, and your energy. Most women eating a fairly normal diet are getting significantly less than they need, and they wonder why they are always hungry and not seeing results despite their efforts. Protein is the missing piece for so many people.

EASY SOURCES

- Eggs and cottage cheese
- Greek yogurt with at least 15 grams of protein per serving
- Chicken, turkey, salmon, tuna
- Lentils, chickpeas, black beans
- Edamame, tofu, tempeh
- A protein smoothie when you are truly short on time

YOUR ACTION STEP

Think back over yesterday. Did every meal have a protein source? If not, where could you add one easily next time?



Lesson 2.4 — Fiber Is Your Best Friend

WHAT FIBER DOES

Fiber slows digestion down in the best possible way, keeping you full for longer and preventing the blood sugar spikes that cause cravings. It feeds your beneficial gut bacteria. It helps your body move things through and remove what it no longer needs, including excess hormones. Most women are not eating nearly enough of it.

EASY WAYS TO EAT MORE FIBER

- Add vegetables to every meal, frozen vegetables absolutely count
- Choose fruit as a snack instead of crackers or something packaged
- Add a spoonful of chia seeds or ground flaxseed to your smoothie or yogurt
- Choose whole grain bread, wraps, or pasta when you have the option
- Throw a handful of beans into soups, salads, or bowls

YOUR ACTION STEP

Pick one fiber addition from the list above and try it this week. That is all. Just one thing. Berries in your yogurt, spinach in your eggs, a handful of black beans in your lunch bowl.



Lesson 2.5 — Stop Being Afraid of Fat

THE TRUTH ABOUT FAT

Dietary fat does not make you fat. That was a myth that took hold in the nineties and did a lot of damage to a lot of women's health. Your body absolutely requires healthy fat to produce hormones, absorb vitamins, maintain your brain function, keep your skin and hair healthy, and feel satisfied after meals. When women cut fat, cravings almost always get worse, not better.

HEALTHY FAT SOURCES TO INCLUDE REGULARLY

- Avocado and avocado oil
- Olive oil, used generously in cooking
- A small handful of nuts as a snack
- Salmon and other fatty fish at least twice a week
- Eggs, including the yolk
- Full fat Greek yogurt

YOUR ACTION STEP

This week, stop avoiding fat. Add half an avocado to one meal per day, or cook with olive oil instead of cooking spray. Notice how much fuller you feel afterward.



Lesson 2.6 — Smarter Carbs, Not No Carbs

THIS IS NOT A LOW CARB COURSE

Carbohydrates are your body's primary source of energy. Cutting them completely makes you feel exhausted, irritable, and even more obsessed with food. The goal is not fewer carbs. The goal is choosing carbs that give you steady, lasting fuel rather than a quick spike followed by a hard crash.

CARBS THAT SUPPORT YOUR ENERGY

- Sweet potato, regular potato, and other root vegetables
- Oats and overnight oats
- Brown rice, quinoa, and farro
- Whole grain bread and sourdough
- Fruit in its whole form
- Lentils and legumes, which are also protein

YOUR ACTION STEP

Swap one refined carb this week for a whole food version. White rice to brown rice or quinoa. Regular pasta to whole wheat. White toast to sourdough. One swap. That is it.



Lesson 2.7 — Hydration Is Part of Your Nutrition

SOMETHING MOST PEOPLE MISS

Your body uses the same pathways to signal thirst and hunger. When you are dehydrated, which most of us are more often than we realize, your brain can send what feels like a hunger signal even when what your body actually needs is water. Before you reach for a snack, especially when you just ate not that long ago, drink a glass of water first and wait ten minutes. You will be surprised how often the craving simply disappears.

WHAT TO AIM FOR

Around eight to ten glasses of water throughout the day. A large water bottle you refill twice is the easiest way to track it. Herbal teas and sparkling water count. Add lemon, mint, or cucumber if plain water feels boring.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Get a water bottle you actually like and fill it first thing each morning. When a craving hits between meals, drink a full glass of water and wait ten minutes before deciding if you are truly hungry.

MODULE 2 — THE BALANCED PLATE AT A GLANCE

☐ Half the plate is colorful vegetables or salad

☐ A quarter is quality protein

☐ A quarter is a whole food carb

☐ A small drizzle of healthy fat

☐ A glass of water on the side always

☐ One whole food swap made this week

MODULE THREE · 6 LESSONS

Digestion and Gut Support

Bloating, sluggishness, that constant uncomfortable fullness after meals. These are some of the most common postpartum complaints and they are almost entirely addressable with very simple habits. Your gut affects everything, your energy, your mood, your weight, your skin. Let us take care of it.



Lesson 3.1 — Slow Down When You Eat

WHAT THIS MEANS IN PRACTICE

Chewing your food slowly and thoroughly before swallowing. Putting your fork down between bites. Not eating standing at the counter or while walking around. Sitting down for your meals, even for ten minutes.

WHY THIS CHANGES EVERYTHING

Digestion starts in your mouth, not your stomach. When you chew properly, you are breaking food into smaller pieces and mixing it with digestive enzymes that begin breaking it down before it even reaches your gut. When you rush, large chunks arrive in your digestive system before it is ready, which causes bloating, gas, and poor nutrient absorption. Slowing down is not optional for digestion. It is foundational.

YOUR ACTION STEP

At your next meal, sit down, take three slow breaths before you start, and put your fork down between every bite. Notice how different you feel twenty minutes after eating compared to your usual pace.



Lesson 3.2 — Walk After Meals

WHAT THIS IS

A gentle ten to fifteen minute walk after eating. Not a workout. Not a power walk. Just movement. A slow stroll around the block, around your yard, even laps inside your house counts when the weather is bad or the baby is asleep.

WHY THIS IS WORTH DOING

Post-meal movement is one of the most effective habits for supporting blood sugar balance after eating. It blunts the blood sugar spike that naturally follows a meal, which means less energy crash afterward, less intense cravings later, and over time more efficient fat metabolism. It also physically moves food through your digestive system and reduces bloating. This one habit alone, done consistently, creates noticeable changes.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Tomorrow after lunch or dinner, take a ten minute walk. Take the baby if you need to. Put headphones in if that helps. Make it something you look forward to, not something else on the list.



Lesson 3.3 — Warm Foods and Drinks for a Happy Gut

WHAT THIS LOOKS LIKE

Herbal teas after meals. Warm soups and stews regularly. Cooked vegetables alongside raw ones. Warm water with lemon in the morning. Just adding warmth where you can, rather than always reaching for something cold.

WHY IT MATTERS POSTPARTUM ESPECIALLY

Warm foods are generally easier on the digestive system than cold or raw foods. Postpartum digestion is often slower and more sensitive than it was before, and giving it less work to do can meaningfully reduce bloating and discomfort. There is also something deeply calming about a warm meal or a warm drink. Your nervous system responds to warmth.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Tonight after dinner, brew a cup of ginger or peppermint tea. Sit down and drink it slowly without your phone. Notice how your belly and your whole body feel twenty minutes later.



Lesson 3.4 — Foods That Feed Your Gut

WHAT GUT-SUPPORTIVE EATING MEANS

Inside your digestive system is a community of trillions of bacteria that play a role in almost everything: your digestion, your immune system, your mood, your metabolism, even how efficiently your body processes and removes excess hormones. The food you eat either feeds the helpful bacteria or crowds them out.

FOODS TO INCLUDE REGULARLY

- Fermented foods: Greek yogurt with live cultures, kefir, sauerkraut, kimchi, and miso
- Prebiotic foods that feed your good bacteria: garlic, onion, bananas, oats, and asparagus
- Anti-bloat herbs and spices: ginger, fennel, peppermint, and turmeric in cooking or as teas
- High fiber produce as covered in Module 2

YOUR ACTION STEP

Add one fermented food to your routine this week. Greek yogurt with live cultures is the easiest starting point. Check the label to make sure it says live and active cultures.



Lesson 3.5 — What Is Actually Causing the Bloating

YOU ARE NOT IMAGINING IT

Bloating is one of the most common postpartum complaints and it is almost always coming from something specific. The good news is that identifying the source makes it much more manageable than just suffering through it.

COMMON CAUSES AND WHAT TO DO

- Eating too fast: slow down and chew, as covered in Lesson 3.1
- Too many raw vegetables at once: introduce cooked options alongside raw
- Not drinking enough water through the day
- Low gut bacteria diversity: add fermented foods daily
- High stress, which directly slows and disrupts digestion
- Too much caffeine, especially on an empty stomach
- Eating while distracted or rushed

YOUR ACTION STEP

Read through that list and identify your most likely trigger. Pick one thing to address this week. Just one. Bloating rarely has a single cause but it absolutely responds to these kinds of small consistent shifts.



Lesson 3.6 — Your Body Cannot Digest When It Is Stressed

THIS IS SOMETHING MOST PEOPLE NEVER LEARN

Your nervous system has two primary states. Fight or flight, which is stress mode, and rest and digest, which is calm mode. When you are in stress mode, even low-grade background stress which most postpartum moms live in constantly, your body actually diverts blood flow away from your digestive system. Digestion is not considered essential in that moment.

WHAT THIS MEANS FOR YOU

If you are eating while stressed, distracted, rushed, or scrolling, your body is likely not digesting that food well, no matter how healthy it is. You can eat the most nourishing meal in the world and not absorb much of it if your nervous system is activated while you eat it. Sitting down, slowing down, and taking a few breaths before eating is not just a mindfulness practice. It is a physiological shift that makes digestion function properly.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Choose one meal per day to eat without your phone, without the television, without multitasking. Sit down. Take three slow breaths before your first bite. Even ten quiet minutes changes the environment your body digests in.

MODULE 3 CHECKLIST — GUT HEALTH DAILY HABITS



Sitting down and chewing slowly at least once per day



A ten minute walk after at least one meal



One cup of herbal tea after dinner



One fermented food included daily



At least one phone-free meal per day



Eight or more glasses of water daily

MODULE FOUR · 5 LESSONS

Movement That Works Postpartum

More is not better. Harder is not always better. The right kind of movement for where your body is right now is gentle, consistent, and sustainable. This module will help you find that.



Lesson 4.1 — Walking Is Genuinely Enough

I NEED YOU TO BELIEVE THIS ONE

Daily walking is one of the most effective, most underrated, and most sustainable forms of movement for postpartum bodies. It is not a consolation prize for when you cannot do a real workout. It is a genuinely powerful habit that supports blood sugar balance, cortisol regulation, digestion, mood, cardiovascular health, and fat metabolism. It costs nothing, requires no equipment, and you can do it with your baby.

WHAT TO AIM FOR

Twenty to thirty minutes daily. It does not have to be fast. A comfortable pace where you can hold a conversation is perfect. Morning walks tend to have the best effect on mood and energy for the rest of the day, but any time works. Just get outside and move.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Schedule your walk for the next five days right now. Put it in your calendar like an appointment. Not an intention, an appointment. Twenty minutes minimum. Keep it.



Lesson 4.2 — Pilates and Why Postpartum Bodies Love It

WHAT PILATES IS

Pilates is a low-impact method of movement that focuses on strengthening the deep core muscles, improving posture, building body awareness, and restoring function from the inside out. It uses controlled, precise movements rather than high repetitions or heavy loads. You can do it on a mat at home with no equipment, or in a studio with a reformer machine.

WHY IT IS PARTICULARLY WELL-SUITED FOR POSTPARTUM

Pregnancy and birth change the core and pelvic floor significantly. Pilates is one of the most respected forms of movement for rebuilding that deep foundation safely. It strengthens without straining. It is calming for the nervous system, which matters enormously for postpartum women. And because the movements are controlled and intentional, there is a real mind-body reconnection that happens, which many women say is exactly what they needed to start feeling at home in their bodies again.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Search beginner postpartum Pilates on YouTube this week and bookmark two or three videos you can rotate through. Try one this week. Start with twenty minutes and see how you feel.



Lesson 4.3 — Simple Strength Training, Twice a Week

WHY STRENGTH TRAINING MATTERS

Muscle tissue is metabolically active. The more lean muscle you carry, the more efficiently your metabolism runs, even at rest. Strength training also supports bone density, posture, mental health, confidence, and long-term hormonal balance. You do not have to go to a gym. You do not need heavy weights. Bodyweight exercises done consistently twice a week are genuinely enough to make a meaningful difference.

A SIMPLE BEGINNER ROUTINE TO START WITH

- Squats: 3 sets of 10 reps
- Glute bridges: 3 sets of 12 reps
- Modified push-ups from the knees: 3 sets of 8 reps
- Bent-over rows with light dumbbells or resistance bands: 3 sets of 10
- Bird-dog for core stability: 3 sets of 8 each side

YOUR ACTION STEP

Try this routine once this week. It should take about twenty to twenty-five minutes. Schedule it like your walk. Modify everything. The goal is building the habit and gradually building strength over time.



Lesson 4.4 — Why Doing Too Much Backfires

SOMETHING I WISH I HAD KNOWN EARLIER

More exercise is not always better. For postpartum women especially, training too hard too often can raise cortisol chronically, which disrupts sleep, intensifies cravings, slows metabolism, and keeps the body in a stress state that actually makes fat loss harder, not easier. If you are exercising intensely every day and not seeing results, it may not be that you need to do more. It may be that you need to do slightly less and recover more.

SIGNS YOU MIGHT BE OVERDOING IT

- Feeling more tired after workouts, not energized
- Intense cravings for sugar in the hours after exercise
- Sleep getting worse despite more physical activity
- Mood dipping after sessions rather than lifting
- Dreading your workouts instead of feeling drawn to them

YOUR ACTION STEP

Commit to the schedule: walking daily, Pilates or strength training two to three times per week, and at least two genuine rest days. Honor the rest days as much as the active ones.



Lesson 4.5 — Rest Is Where the Change Actually Happens

THE PART NOBODY TALKS ABOUT

Your body does not change during exercise. It changes during recovery. Muscle rebuilds while you rest. Hormones rebalance while you sleep. Your nervous system resets during downtime. Without adequate rest, the work you put in during your workouts produces a fraction of the results it otherwise would. Rest is not the absence of progress. Rest is where progress happens.

WHAT TO PRIORITIZE

Sleep as much as your life genuinely allows. Nap when the baby naps if you need it. A twenty-minute nap can reset your afternoon more effectively than another cup of coffee. Ask for help so you can rest. Protect your recovery days from the impulse to fill them with more.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Identify one thing this week you can let go of or hand off to someone else so you can have more rest. It does not have to be big. Even one thing creates space.

MODULE 4 — A SIMPLE WEEKLY MOVEMENT TEMPLATE

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ Monday: 30-min walk plus strength training | ☐ Tuesday: 20-min gentle walk, rest from intensity |
| ☐ Wednesday: 30-min walk plus Pilates session | ☐ Thursday: 20-min walk, full rest from structured exercise |
| ☐ Friday: 30-min walk plus strength training | ☐ Sunday: Full rest day, fully protected |

MODULE FIVE · 5 LESSONS

Cycle-Aware Wellness

Your energy, appetite, mood, and recovery all shift throughout the month. Once you understand the pattern, you stop feeling like something is wrong with you on the hard weeks and start giving yourself exactly what you need instead.



Lesson 5.1 — Your Cycle in Simple Terms

THE FOUR PHASES SIMPLY EXPLAINED

- Menstrual, Days 1 to 5: Your period. Energy is low. Your body is doing significant internal work. This is a rest phase.
- Follicular, Days 6 to 13: Energy begins to climb. Mood improves. Great time to tackle harder things and push a little more in workouts.
- Ovulatory, Days 14 to 17: Peak energy, peak mood, peak motivation. This is your best week for strength training and higher intensity movement.
- Luteal, Days 18 to 28: Energy gradually decreases. Your body needs more nourishment and more rest in this phase, not more pushing.

WHY THIS INFORMATION CHANGES EVERYTHING

When you know which phase you are in, you stop blaming yourself for having zero motivation the week before your period. You start planning for it instead. You rest when your body signals rest and push when it is ready to go. That is working with your body, not against it.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Download a simple period tracking app like Clue or Flo and start logging your cycle and daily energy level with one word: high, medium, or low. Do this for one full cycle and notice the pattern.



Lesson 5.2 — Matching Your Workouts to Your Energy

THE BASIC GUIDE BY PHASE

- Menstrual: Rest, gentle walks, restorative Pilates. Honor the fatigue rather than fighting it.
- Follicular: Energy is rising. Great time to try a new workout or go a little longer.
- Ovulatory: Your peak. This is the week for your harder strength sessions and longer walks.
- Luteal: Dial back intensity gradually. Pilates, gentle strength work, and walks rather than hard cardio especially in the final days before your period.

WHY THIS MATTERS SO MUCH

So many women experience the luteal phase as a personal failure. Their motivation drops, their workouts feel harder, they feel more tired. They are not losing discipline. Their body is doing intensive hormonal work and genuinely needs less external demand placed on it. Reducing intensity during this phase is not quitting. It is intelligent.

YOUR ACTION STEP

This month, pay attention to which week feels hardest for workouts. That is almost certainly your luteal phase. Give yourself explicit permission to reduce intensity during that week.



Lesson 5.3 — Why Pre-Period Cravings Are Not Your Fault

WHAT IS ACTUALLY HAPPENING

In the week before your period, progesterone rises, your resting metabolic rate increases slightly, your body temperature runs a little higher, and serotonin tends to dip. Your brain then drives you toward quick carbohydrates and sugar because that is the fastest way to get a serotonin boost. Before reaching for a sweet snack, drink a full glass of water first and wait ten minutes, because dehydration can amplify luteal phase cravings significantly. The cravings are not random. They are your body communicating a real need.

HOW TO WORK WITH THIS, NOT AGAINST IT

- Eat more warming, satisfying complex carbohydrates this week: sweet potato, oats, brown rice, root vegetables
- Include magnesium-rich foods: pumpkin seeds, dark leafy greens, dark chocolate
- Have a small piece of quality dark chocolate and fully enjoy it without guilt
- Prioritize sleep even more than usual this week

YOUR ACTION STEP

Next time your cravings feel intense, ask yourself where you are in your cycle before you judge yourself. Then respond with nourishment. Give your body what it is actually asking for.



Lesson 5.4 — How to Support Your Luteal Phase

THINK OF THIS PHASE AS YOUR RECOVERY WEEK

The luteal phase, roughly days fifteen through twenty-eight, is when your body is doing significant internal work. It does not need more stress placed on it from the outside. It needs support from the inside.

WHAT SUPPORT LOOKS LIKE DURING THIS PHASE

- More sleep and more rest than other weeks
- Lighter movement: Pilates, walks, gentle stretching rather than intense training
- Warm, nourishing food: soups, stews, roasted vegetables, slow cooked meals
- Less caffeine and alcohol as both can worsen symptoms significantly
- More intentional calming activities: baths, reading, time outside, creative things you enjoy
- More water, as hydration needs increase during this phase

YOUR ACTION STEP

Find the last week before your next period on your calendar and block one small self-care activity into each day of that week. Even just ten minutes. Plan for it the way you plan for everything else.



Lesson 5.5 — Rest Is Productive

A REFRAKE WORTH HOLDING ONTO

Some phases of your cycle are designed for high output. Others are designed for restoration and renewal. Both are necessary. Both are productive. A resting body is not a lazy body. It is a body that is repairing, rebalancing, and preparing to be stronger again.

TRY REPLACING THESE THOUGHTS

Instead of "I was lazy this week" try "I gave my body what it needed and it will be stronger for it next week." Instead of "I failed at my routine" try "I listened to my body and adjusted. That is not weakness. That is wisdom."

YOUR ACTION STEP

Write this somewhere you will see it regularly: Rest is not the opposite of progress. Rest is how progress happens.

MODULE 5 — YOUR SIMPLE CYCLE ENERGY GUIDE

○ Week 1 your period: Rest, warmth, gentle walks, nourishing food

○ Week 2 follicular: Energy is rising. Try new things. Build momentum.

○ Week 3 ovulation: Your peak week. Use it well for harder effort.

○ Week 4 luteal: Slow down intentionally. More rest. More nourishment. No guilt.

MODULE SIX · 5 LESSONS

Stress, Mood and Lasting Habits

This is the module I wish every postpartum mom received first. Because no amount of clean eating or consistent exercise can fully overcome what chronic unmanaged stress does to your body. Nervous system care is not optional. It is the foundation of everything.



Lesson 6.1 — Why Stress Is Making Everything Harder

WHAT CHRONIC STRESS ACTUALLY DOES TO YOUR BODY

When you are under ongoing stress, which describes almost every postpartum mom, your body produces elevated cortisol consistently. Cortisol is not a bad hormone. You need it. But chronically high cortisol disrupts nearly everything you are trying to support with this course. It drives intense cravings for sugar and comfort food. It signals the body to store fat, particularly around the belly. It disrupts sleep quality. It slows digestion. It affects mood, motivation, and your ability to feel calm in your own skin. This is not a personal failure. This is biology responding to real input.

WHY THIS INFORMATION IS ACTUALLY HOPEFUL

If stress is contributing to how you feel, then reducing your stress load and supporting your nervous system is one of the most powerful changes you can make. And the tools for doing this are simple, accessible, and free. That is what the rest of this module is about.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Take a moment to genuinely acknowledge how much you are carrying right now. Not to dwell there, but to recognize it honestly. You are not failing. You are depleted and stressed, and that is fixable with the right support.



Lesson 6.2 — Emotional Eating Without the Shame

LET US BE HONEST ABOUT THIS

Emotional eating is not a moral failing. It is an incredibly common and understandable response to stress, exhaustion, loneliness, and overwhelm, all of which postpartum life delivers in abundance. Food offers comfort, pleasure, and a moment of relief. Using it that way sometimes is completely human. The problem only becomes significant when it is your primary coping mechanism and it is making you feel worse, not better, over time.

THE PAUSE PRACTICE

This is not about willpower. It is about building awareness. When a craving hits suddenly and intensely, especially not long after eating, pause for sixty seconds. Ask yourself honestly: am I physically hungry right now, or is there something else going on? Then drink a glass of water, because dehydration and emotional tension can trigger identical craving signals. Wait ten minutes. If you are still hungry after that, eat. But often you will find the urge softens once you have identified what it actually was.

YOUR ACTION STEP

This week, when a craving comes on suddenly, pause for sixty seconds. Drink a glass of water. Ask yourself what is actually happening. No judgment, just curiosity. You are building self-awareness, not trying to restrict yourself.



Lesson 6.3 — Daily Calming Habits and Gratitude

NERVOUS SYSTEM SUPPORT IS NOT ONE BIG THING

It is many small things done consistently. When you build little moments of calm and grounding into your day regularly, your baseline stress level genuinely comes down over time. Your body spends less time in fight-or-flight and more time in the rest-and-digest state where digestion works properly, cravings are quieter, mood is more stable, and sleep is deeper.

SIMPLE TOOLS THAT ACTUALLY WORK

- Slow breathing: four counts in through the nose, six counts out through the mouth. Do this for two minutes when you feel tension rising. The extended exhale activates your calm state almost immediately.
- Grounding: when you feel overwhelmed, feel your feet on the floor, name five things you can see around you, and take three slow breaths. This interrupts the stress response quickly.
- Gratitude: writing down two or three specific things you are grateful for each day genuinely shifts the nervous system toward a calmer state over time. Specific is better than general. Not just your family but the way your baby laughed this morning. That specificity is what makes it land.
- Warmth: a warm bath, a heating pad, a cup of herbal tea, a warm shower at the end of the day. Warmth signals safety to your nervous system.
- Phone boundaries: thirty minutes without your phone, especially in the morning and before bed. The constant scroll keeps your brain in low-grade alert mode.
- Music: putting on a song you genuinely love for three minutes changes your physiological state. Use this one freely.

YOUR ACTION STEP

Choose three of these habits and add them to your week. Morning calm ritual counts as one of them if you started that in Module 1. Gratitude journaling before bed is a powerful second. Slow breathing when stress spikes is a transformative third.



Lesson 6.4 — Progress Beyond the Scale

WHAT THE SCALE ACTUALLY MEASURES

Your relationship with gravity. That is it. It does not measure your muscle gain, your reduced inflammation, your improved digestion, your stabilized hormones, your better sleep, your increased energy, or your mental health. It is one data point and it is often a misleading one, especially postpartum, where fluid retention, hormonal shifts, and cycle timing can cause the number to swing by several pounds within a single week without any real change in body composition.

BETTER WAYS TO MEASURE PROGRESS

- How is your energy in the afternoon compared to a month ago?
- How is your digestion and are you experiencing less bloating?
- How do your clothes fit, not just the number on the tag?
- How are your moods and emotional stability throughout the day?
- How are your cravings compared to when you started?
- How is your skin, your hair, your nails?
- How do you feel about yourself?

YOUR ACTION STEP

Write down three non-scale markers of progress that matter to you right now. Refer back to these on any day the scale feels discouraging. Those three things are the real picture.



Lesson 6.5 — Consistency Over Perfection, Every Time

THE MOST IMPORTANT THING I CAN TELL YOU

The woman who drinks her warm water most mornings, who takes her walk most days, who eats balanced meals most of the time, who rests when her body needs it, and who keeps coming back to these habits month after month, even when she misses days, even when life gets hard, that woman gets results. Not the woman who follows everything perfectly for two weeks and then burns out because it was not sustainable.

WHEN YOU HAVE A HARD DAY OR A HARD WEEK

You do not start over on Monday. There is no starting over. You just pick back up at the very next meal, the very next morning, the very next walk. You were never off track. You just had a harder stretch. The habit is still there. Come back to it without drama, without guilt, without the story that you have failed. Just come back. That is what consistency actually looks like in real life.

YOUR FINAL ACTION STEP

Write this somewhere you will see it and read it often: I do not need to be perfect. I just need to keep coming back. And I can always start again with the very next choice.

MODULE 6 — WEEKLY NON-SCALE PROGRESS CHECK-IN



Energy levels this week, 1 to 10: ___



Sleep quality this week, 1 to 10: ___



Digestive comfort and bloating, 1 to 10:



Craving intensity, 1 is low and 10 is intense:



Mood and emotional steadiness, 1 to 10:



One thing I am genuinely proud of this week: ___

Your Daily Habit Tracker

Click the circles to check off your habits each day. Watch your week fill in.

	M	T	W	T	F	S	S
 Morning warm water before anything	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Morning sunlight or fresh air	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Protein at breakfast	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Coffee came after food	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Morning calm ritual or gratitude	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Balanced plate at lunch or dinner	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Eight or more glasses of water	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Daily walk completed	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Ate slowly at one meal	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Herbal tea after dinner	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐
 Phone-free meal today	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐	☐



In bed by 10pm



You showed up. That matters.

Every small choice you make in the direction of your own health is a form of love for yourself and for your family. Keep going, even slowly. Especially slowly. This is a long game and you are already playing it.

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